

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniproper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of hands-on experience securing large enterprise environments. I specialise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platform engineering, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) administration, and robust security operations across global hybrid infrastructure. I have deep expertise with CrowdStrike Falcon across endpoint prevention, detection, and threat hunting, and have designed and built Microsoft Sentinel SIEM workspaces including analytics rules, playbooks, and workbooks from the ground up. I have managed identity and access security through Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), enforced Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, administered email security gateways including Mimecast, and led vulnerability management programmes end-to-end. I have served as senior escalation lead for complex incidents, delivered security awareness training, and driven penetration test finding remediation. I am seeking a senior engineering role within a focused, high-impact security team in the financial services or asset management sector, where I can take technical ownership of implementing, hardening, and continuously improving robust security across a global infrastructure.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM / SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), detection engineering, analytics rules, Logic Apps playbooks, automated response workflows; Splunk (SPL) familiarity
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR / XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover (Expert); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Email and Web Security Gateways:** Mimecast email security; Check Point Harmony endpoint and gateway; email threat protection and gateway policy management
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), group policy, RBAC
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM platform; least-privilege enforcement, privileged session management
- **Mobile Device and Application Management:** Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; penetration test finding remediation, risk-based remediation prioritisation
- **Network and Perimeter Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall administration; WAF / DDoS protection principles; IDS / IPS management; security certificate lifecycle
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, proactive threat hunting, senior escalation lead, playbook authoring
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR automation, Logic Apps
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, JISC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer — University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2025 – Present*

- Take technical ownership of the CrowdStrike Falcon platform across 8,000+ endpoints and servers, managing and optimising detection configurations, workflows, and alert response across endpoint, server, and cloud environments using Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover, and the Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM).

- Design, build, and maintain the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM workspace including custom analytics rules, Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection logic, Logic Apps playbooks for automated incident response, and workbooks for security reporting and executive dashboards.
- Administer Mimecast email security gateway, configuring policies for anti-phishing, anti-spoofing, data loss prevention, and threat intelligence-enriched email analysis.
- Manage the BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) platform, enforcing least-privilege access controls, privileged session management, and periodic access review across all critical systems.
- Configure and maintain Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), and role-based access controls across all enterprise applications and cloud services.
- Serve as senior escalation lead for Tier 2 and Tier 3 security incidents, leading investigations across endpoint, identity, cloud, and email vectors using the NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle and MITRE ATT&CK framework.
- Manage the enterprise vulnerability management programme using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus; track and drive remediation of penetration test findings with IT and development teams.
- Administer Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) across the 8,000-user estate, enforcing compliance baselines and device configuration policies.
- Build and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) workflows using PowerShell and Logic Apps, accelerating alert triage, enrichment, and incident response workflows.
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulation programmes, supporting a security-first culture across the organisation.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity — University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2022 – March 2025

- Performed daily security monitoring, SIEM alert triage, and investigation of security incidents across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud platforms.
- Supported the deployment and managed day-to-day operations of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across an 8,000-user estate.
- Managed identity and access operations in Azure Active Directory including conditional access policy review, group policy administration, MFA enforcement, and account lifecycle management.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Nessus, produced risk-prioritised remediation reports, and coordinated closure of critical and high findings with infrastructure teams.
- Contributed to incident response activities, escalating to senior engineers and preparing post-incident reports and lessons-learned documentation.
- Delivered security awareness training to staff and supported phishing simulation exercises, reducing click-through rates on simulated phishing campaigns significantly over time.
- Contributed to security policy development and Cyber Essentials+ and ISO 27001 compliance reviews.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure — HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 – March 2022

- Managed security controls, IT infrastructure, and quality assurance processes within a regulated SaaS and FinTech environment handling supplier and procurement data for global enterprises.
- Monitored security events, administered access management, and supported vulnerability remediation and patching processes.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities and supported internal and external audit preparation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and operationalised the CrowdStrike Falcon platform across 8,000+ endpoints at UAL, building a hybrid Security Operations Centre (SOC) that significantly reduced mean time to detect and contain threats, and introduced proactive threat hunting capability.
- Designed and implemented the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM workspace from the ground up, authoring custom analytics rules and KQL-based detection queries, reducing manual alert handling effort by over 60% through SOAR automation.

- Led the enterprise BeyondTrust PAM deployment, eliminating uncontrolled privileged access across all critical systems and achieving consistent least-privilege enforcement organisation-wide.
- Authored and maintained incident response playbooks aligned to NIST 800-61, improving response consistency and measurably reducing time to resolve high-severity security incidents.
- Managed end-to-end vulnerability management using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, coordinating remediation and achieving sustained reduction in critical exposure across each quarterly cycle.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)